

Rui Chen, PhD Student

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Michigan State University
East Lansing, MI

Education

2029	Ph.D.	Human Development and Family Studies Michigan State University East Lansing, MI
2024	M.Ed.	Early Childhood Education Dissertation: Memory into Reality: How do childhood experiences influence teacher-child interactions? Beijing Normal University Beijing, China
2021	B. Ed.	Early Childhood Education Ningbo University Zhejiang, China

Publications

Peer-reviewed Journal Articles

1. **Chen, R.**, Zhang, R., Li, Y., & Hu, Z. (2023). Does the Physical Kindergarten Environment or Teacher-Child Interaction Have a Greater Impact on Children's Social Development? —Research based on three public kindergartens. *Early Education (Chinese)*, 29, 28-33.
2. Tao, Z., & **Chen, R.** (2020). From Never Forgetting the True “Heart” of Education to Hold on to the Original Intention of Moral Education: To Review “Rethinking Moral Education.” *Research in Educational Development (Chinese)*, 40(12), 80-84. doi: 10.14121/cnk.1008-3855.2020.12.0. (Composite Impact Factor:3.122

Under Review

1. Zhang, Z., Aubrey, S., **Chen, R.**, Yihan, L., Thomas, Chiu. (under review). Comparing the Impact of Synchronous and Asynchronous Generative AI -Assisted Learning in K-12 Education, Submitted to *Distance Education*, May 2025.

In Preparation

1. **Chen, R.** Expanding the Whole Teacher Framework: A scoping review on the role of teacher characteristics in the efficacy of teacher training.
2. **Chen, R.** Enhancing behavior guidance practices through teacher training and education.
3. **Chen, R.** Childhood Adversity, Adult Attachment, and Career Choices among Pre-service Teachers: Evidence from the CUPID Multi-University Dataset.

Book Chapters

1. **Chen, R., & Feng, W.** (2023). Tao Xingzhi's Educational Thought and Practice. In W. Feng (Eds.), *Zhongwai xueqian jiaoyu lunzhu daodu* [Guided readings of Chinese and international preschool education classics] (pp. 92-107). Beijing Normal University Press. [In Chinese]
2. **Chen, R., & Feng, W.** (2023). Special topic on children and children's education. In W. Feng (Ed.), *Zhongwai xueqian jiaoyu lunzhu daodu* [Guided readings of Chinese and international preschool education classics] (pp. 159-189). Beijing Normal University Press. [In Chinese]
3. **Chen, R., & Feng, W.** (2024). Design and implementation of domain-specific teaching activities from a deep learning perspective. In W. Feng (Ed.), *Children's deep learning in teaching activities* (pp. 77-214). Educational Science Publishing House. [In Chinese]

Funded Research

PI: *Expanding the Whole Teacher Framework: A Scoping Review on the Role of Teachers Characteristics in the Efficacy of Teacher Training Early Start Program*, College of Social Sciences, MSU, 2026-2027
Amount: \$3,000

PI: *Expanding the Whole Teacher Framework: A Scoping Review on the Role of Teachers Characteristics in the Efficacy of Teacher Training Early Start Program*, College of Social Sciences, MSU, 2025-2026
Amount: \$3,000

PI: *Expanding the Whole Teacher Framework: A Scoping Review on the Role of Teachers Characteristics in the Efficacy of Teacher Training Early Start Program*, College of Social Sciences, MSU, 2024-2025
Amount: \$5,000

PI: *The Influence of Preschool Physical Environment and Teacher-Child Interaction on Children's Social Development* Collaborative Innovation Center of Assessment for Basic Education Quality, Beijing Normal University, China, 2022-2023
Amount: \$800

PI: *Perceptions of Preschool Education Quality Among Teachers and Parents in Developed Coastal Regions* Zhejiang Xinmiao Talent Program, College of Teacher Education, Ningbo University, 2019-2020
Amount: \$2,000

Academic Presentations

International and National

1. **Chen, R.,** Vallotton, C. D. (June 23, 2026). Childhood Adversity, Adult Attachment, and Career Choices among Pre-service Teachers: Evidence from the CUPID Multi-University Dataset. Poster submitted for the *National Research Conference on Early Childhood*, June 22-24 2026, Arlington, VA.

2. **Chen, R.**, Vallotton, C. D., & Graves, C. (June 23, 2026). Expanding the Whole Teacher Framework: A scoping review on the role of teacher characteristics in the efficacy of teacher training. Poster submitted for the *National Research Conference on Early Childhood*, June 22-24 2026, Arlington, VA.
3. Vallotton, C. D., Brophy-Herb, H., & Patel, P., **Chen, R.**, Edwards, J., ElSaedy, S., Nalamati, S., & Paudel, K. (June 22, 2026). Development of *Internal State Language from Birth to Five Years: First Findings from a Scoping Review*. Poster submitted for the National Research Conference on Early Childhood, June 22-24 2026, Arlington, VA.
4. **Chen, R.**, & Feng, W. (April 24, 2025). *Memory into reality: How childhood experiences affect teacher-child interactions in preschool*. Paper presented at the American Educational Research Association (AERA) Annual Meeting, April 23-27, 2025, Denver, CO
5. **Chen, R.** (July 7, 2023). Does the Physical Kindergarten Environment or Teacher-Child Interaction Have a Greater Impact on Children's Social Development? Paper presented at the Chinese Sociology 2023 Annual Conference, July 7-8, Tianjin, China.
6. **Chen, R.**, Rong, X., & Feng, W. (October 29, 2022). Analysis and Suggestions on Problems of Research-oriented Kindergarten Teachers' Research — Research Based on the Research Proposals of Thirty Teachers. Paper presented at the 16th International Consortium for Universities of Education in East Asia, October 29, 2022, Southwest University, China.

Presentations in Preparation and Under Review

1. **Chen, R.**, & Vallotton, C. (Under review). Enhancing behavior guidance practices through teacher training and education. Poster submitted for the 19th World Congress of the World Association for Infant Mental Health (WAIMH), October 2-6, Toronto, Ontario, Canada.

Research Appointments

Graduate Research Assistant – Child Lab

2024 – Now

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI Supervisor: Claire Vallotton, PhD and Holly Brophy-Herb, PhD

Teaching Appointments

Instructor of Record

2026 Summer

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

HDFS 212: Children, Youth and Family (49 students)

This course presents an ecological perspective on childhood, adolescence, and family interactions. Dynamic relationships between children/adolescents and significant contexts (i.e., family, school, and community) will be examined. Parent-child interactions, as well as socio-cultural factors, will also be analyzed.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

2026 Spring

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

HDFS 321: Curriculum for Children (125 students)

This course teaches child development and accreditation-based curriculum design for early

childhood programs, alongside a supervised lab (HDFS 321L) focused on planning, implementing, and evaluating learning activities, with possible required field trips.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

2025 Fall

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

HDFS 320: Interactions with Children in Groups (120 students)

This course trains students to apply effective verbal and nonverbal communication, interpersonal skills, and positive guidance techniques in their interactions with children in early childhood settings.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

2025 Spring

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

HDFS 321: Curriculum for Children (123 students)

This course teaches child development and accreditation-based curriculum design for early childhood programs, alongside a supervised lab (HDFS 321L) focused on planning, implementing, and evaluating learning activities, with possible required field trips.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

2024 Fall

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

HDFS 320: Interactions with Children in Groups (121 students)

This course trains students to apply effective verbal and nonverbal communication, interpersonal skills, and positive guidance techniques in their interactions with children in early childhood settings.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

2022 Fall

Beijing Normal University, Beijing, China

College Student Mental Health

This course trains college students to maintain mental health and build psychological resilience.

Guest Lectures

2025: *The Invisible Legacy of Family: The Impact of Prenatal Influences and Intergenerational Trauma.* Invited guest lecture for HDFS 414: Parenting at Michigan State University, MI. (60 students)

2025: *Memory into reality: How childhood experiences affect teacher-child. interactions in preschool?* Invited guest lecture for HDFS 320: Interaction with Children in Groups at Michigan State University, MI. (120 students)

Quantitative Experience

- Currently participating in ICPSR Session I, with coursework in Maximum Likelihood Estimation, Evaluating Model Robustness, Time Series and Panel Data, Causal Inference for the Social Sciences.
- Completed graduate-level coursework in Regression Analysis, Multivariate Analysis, Multilevel Modeling, and Missing Data Analysis.
- Completed intensive workshops equivalent to semester-long courses in Mediation and

Moderation and Structural Equation Modeling.

- Will enroll in advanced methods in Intervention research and psychometric theory next semester; plan to take Longitudinal Structural Equation Modeling next semester.
- Highly proficient in SPSS for data entry, data cleaning, coding, analysis, and interpretation of data including use of syntax.
- Highly proficient in Mplus for analysis and interpretation of mediation, moderation, and structural equation models.
- Highly proficient in STATA for analysis and interpretation of multinomial logistic regression models.
- Highly proficient in R for data analysis and interpretation.

Honors and Awards

ICPSR Opportunity Scholarship, University of Michigan, 2026	\$5,782,
including \$2,725 for general session tuition, \$1,757 for housing, \$800 for dining, and a \$500 travel stipend.	
Knorr Mentzer Byers Scholarship, Michigan State University, 2026	\$4,000
Estate of Mary Lewis Scholarship, Michigan State University, 2025	\$5,050
Early Start and Recruitment Top Off Awards, Michigan State University, 2024	\$7,000
First-class Academic Achievement Scholarships, Beijing Normal University, 2021, 2023	\$3,400
Second-class Academic Achievement Scholarships, Beijing Normal University, 2022	\$1,500
Zhejiang Provincial Government Scholarship, Zhejiang Provincial Government (only one recipient in the department), 2018	\$1000

University Services

Chair	2025-Now
Graduate Student Advisory Council	
Department of Human Development and Family Studies, Michigan State University	

Admission Chair	2024-Now
Graduate Student Advisory Council	
Department of Human Development and Family Studies, Michigan State University	

Professional Services
